Hebrew QWERTY + Niqqud Keyboard – Guide

Oct 14, 2026 · @Naran Gheser

What it is

Hebrew QWERTY + Niqqud is a Hebrew keyboard for Windows where each letter sits on the Latin key with a similar sound (B → ב, L → ל, M → מ) and every vowel mark can be typed directly. It is based on the "Hebrew QWERTY" layout (Yoram, 2013): all original keys are unchanged, and the vowels are added on the AltGr key (right Alt).

The installer is the **HebrewQN** folder (usually shared as HebrewQN.zip). It contains:

File	Purpose
setup.exe	the installer — the only file you run
HebrewQN_amd64.msi, HebrewQN_i386.msi, HebrewQN_ia64.msi	64-bit / 32-bit packages, picked automatically by setup.exe
amd64, i386, ia64, wow64 folders	the keyboard files (DLL)

Keep the folder complete: setup.exe does not work on its own.

Requirements: Windows 10 or 11 on an Intel or AMD processor. It does not work on Mac, phones, tablets, or ARM laptops (Snapdragon / Copilot+ PC).

Installation

Installation takes about a minute and ends with a restart.

1. If you received **HebrewQN.zip**, right-click it → **Extract All** → **Extract**.
2. Open the **HebrewQN** folder and double-click **setup.exe**.
3. If "Windows protected your PC" appears, click **More info** → **Run anyway**. The warning appears because the installer is not digitally signed by a company.
4. If Windows asks for administrator permission, click **Yes**.
5. Wait for the installation-complete message.
6. **Restart the computer.** Without a restart the keyboard may not work correctly.

If an older version of this keyboard is already installed, uninstall it first (see Uninstalling) and restart, then install the new one.

Selecting and testing

Switch keyboards with **Win + Space**. All Hebrew keyboards show the "עבר" badge; the new one has "Hebrew QWERTY + Niqqud" underneath. If it only says "Hebrew", pick the entry in the same order as in Settings → Time & language → Language & region → Hebrew ("…") → Language options → Keyboards.

Quick test in Notepad:

1. Open Notepad and select the new keyboard.
2. Press **B** → ב appears.
3. Hold **right Alt**, press **A**, then release both.
4. You should see בַ (a short line under the letter). If nothing appears, a different Hebrew keyboard is selected.

The letters

The Hebrew alphabet has 22 letters, all consonants; five have a final form (sofit) used only at the end of a word. On this keyboard each letter sits on the Latin key with a similar sound, and its final form is on the same key with **Shift**. Some letters have two keys; either one types the same character.

Sounds are Modern Hebrew. Numeric values are the standard ones (final forms in the extended system).

Letter	Name	Sound	Value	Key	Final form
א	alef	silent; carries the vowel	1	A	—
ב	bet / vet	b (with dagesh) / v	2	B or Shift+V	—
ג	gimel	g	3	G	—
ד	dalet	d	4	D	—
ה	he	h (soft)	5	H	—
ו	vav	v; as a vowel u / o	6	U, O or V	—
ז	zayin	z	7	Z	—
ח	ḥet	guttural h (as in “Bach”)	8	J or Shift+H	—
ט	tet	t	9	Y or Shift+T	—
י	yod	y / i	10	I	—
כ	kaf / khaf	k (with dagesh) / guttural kh	20	K or X	Shift+K or Shift+X = ך (500)
ל	lamed	l	30	L	—
מ	mem	m	40	M	Shift+M = ם (600)
נ	nun	n	50	N	Shift+N = ן (700)

Letter	Name	Sound	Value	Key	Final form
ס	samekh	s	60	S	—
ע	ayin	silent in Modern Hebrew	70	E	—
פ	pe / fe	p (with dagesh) / f	80	P or F	Shift+P or Shift+F (800) = ף
צ	tsadi	ts	90	C	Shift+C (900) = ץ
ק	qof	k	100	Q	—
ר	resh	r	200	R	—
ש	shin / sin	sh / s	300	W or Shift+S	—
ת	tav	t	400	T or Shift+Y	—

Watch the swapped keys: T types ת (tav) and Y types ט (tet); with Shift they swap. ע (ayin) is on E, not O.

Shin or sin: a plain ש does not show which one it is; the dot decides. שׁ shin = Shift+W (one press) or W then AltGr+W; שׂ sin = W then AltGr+S.

Letters with dagesh

Dagesh is the dot inside a letter. It is typed the same way for every letter: **the letter key, then ` (the key left of 1)** or **Shift+B**. Example: B, then ` → בּ. If the letter also has a vowel, type the dagesh first, then the vowel: B, `, Shift+A → בָּ.

Letters whose sound changes

In Modern Hebrew, dagesh changes the pronunciation of three letters. These are the ones that matter when reading.

Without dagesh	With dagesh	Name	How to type	Sound without → with
ב	בּ	vet → bet	B, then `	v → b
כ	כּ	khaf → kaf	K, then `	kh → k
ך	ךּ	final khaf → final kaf	Shift+K, then `	kh → k (rare)
פ	פּ	fe → pe	P, then `	f → p

Letters whose sound stays the same

In the other letters, dagesh marks a doubled consonant (dagesh ḥazaq) or, in ג ד ת, an older pronunciation that has disappeared (dagesh qal). In Modern Hebrew the sound stays the same.

With dagesh	Name	How to type	Sound
גּ	gimel	G, then `	g
דּ	dalet	D, then `	d
תּ	tav	T, then `	t
זּ	zayin	Z, then `	z
טּ	tet	Y, then `	t
יּ	yod	I, then `	y
לּ	lamed	L, then `	l
מּ	mem	M, then `	m
נּ	nun	N, then `	n
סּ	samekh	S, then `	s
צּ	tsadi	C, then `	ts
קּ	qof	Q, then `	k
שׁ	shin	W, `, AltGr+W	sh
שׂ	sin	W, `, AltGr+S	s

Special cases

Form	Name	How to type	What it is
וּ	shuruq	Shift+U (one press)	the vowel u, not the consonant v
הּ	he with mapiq	H, then `	at the end of a word: the h is pronounced (otherwise silent)

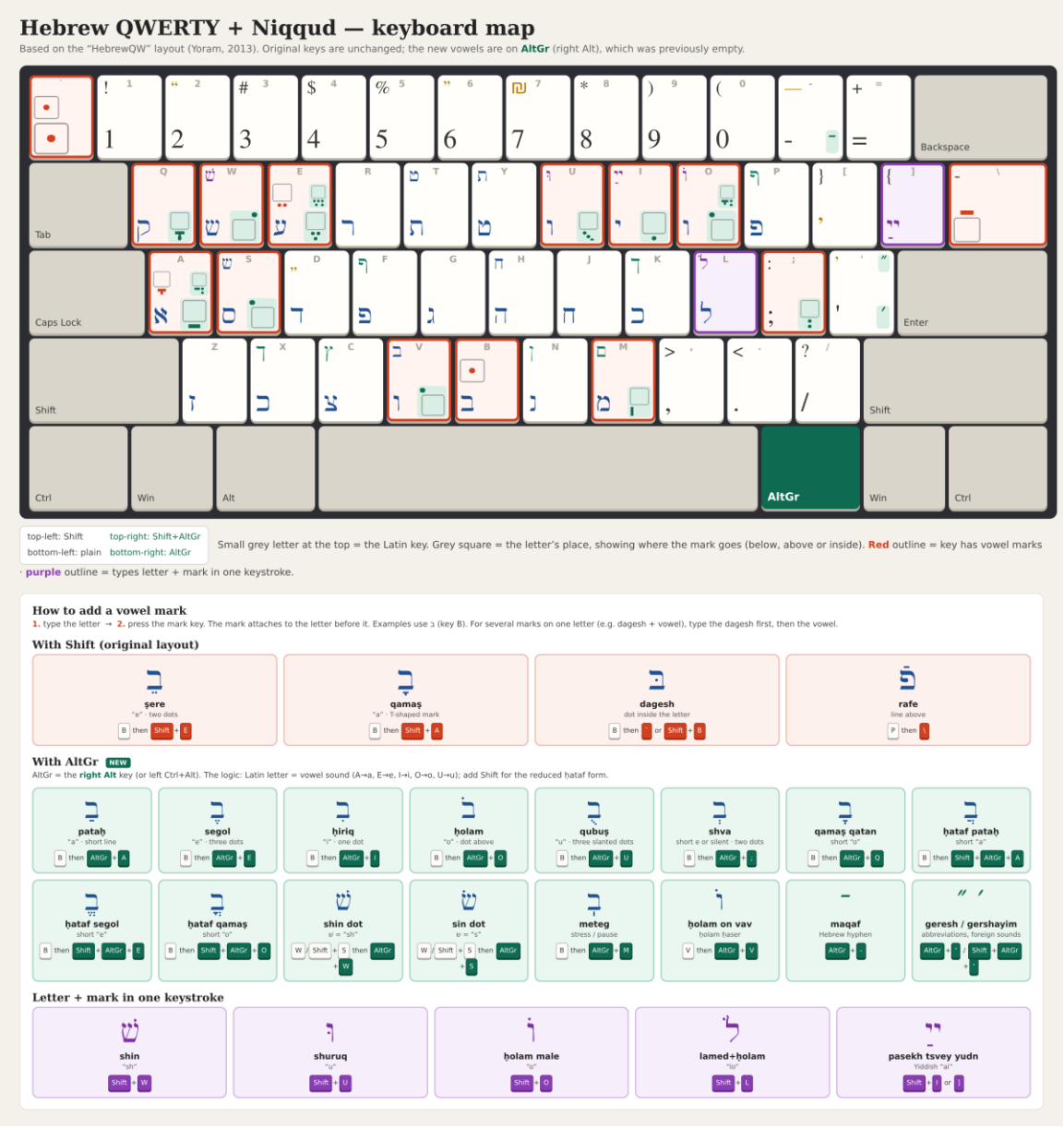
Letters that take no dagesh: א ה ח ע ר. The exception is ה at the end of a word, where the dot is called mapiq.

How to type each niqqud

The rule: **type the letter first, then the mark key right after it.** The mark attaches itself under, inside or above the letter before it. When a letter takes two marks (for example dagesh + vowel), type the dagesh first, then the vowel.

AltGr = the **right Alt** key, held down together with the letter (like Shift). Left-hand alternative: **Ctrl + Alt** on the left. Left Alt alone does not work — in Word it opens the shortcut menu (Esc closes it).

The examples use the letter ב (key B).



Vowels

Mark	Name	Sound	Keys	Example

Mark	Name	Sound	Keys	Example
◌ַ	pataḥ	a	AltGr + A	B, then AltGr+A → בַ
◌ָ	qamaṣ	a	Shift + A	B, then Shift+A → בָ
◌ֶ	segol	e	AltGr + E	B, then AltGr+E → בֶ
◌ֵ	ṣere	e	Shift + E	B, then Shift+E → בֵ
◌ִ	ḥiriq	i	AltGr + I	B, then AltGr+I → בִ
◌ֹ	ḥolam	o	AltGr + O	B, then AltGr+O → בֹ
◌ָ	qamaṣ qatan	short o	AltGr + Q	B, then AltGr+Q → בָ
◌ֻ	qubuṣ	u	AltGr + U	B, then AltGr+U → בֻ
◌ְ	shva	short e or silent	AltGr + ;	B, then AltGr+; → בְ

Reduced vowels (ḥataf)

Same letter as the full vowel, plus Shift.

Mark	Name	Sound	Keys	Example
◌ֲ	ḥataf pataḥ	short a	Shift + AltGr + A	בֲ
◌ֱ	ḥataf segol	short e	Shift + AltGr + E	בֱ
◌ֳ	ḥataf qamaṣ	short o	Shift + AltGr + O	בֳ

Dots and other marks

Mark	Name	Role	Keys	Example
◌ּ	dagesh / mapiq	dot inside the letter (ב v → בּ b)	` (left of 1) or Shift + B	B, then ` → בּ
◌ֿ	rafe	line above, “soft” letter	\	P, then \ → פֿ

Mark	Name	Role	Keys	Example
◌ׁ◌	shin dot	sh = שׁ	AltGr + W	W, then AltGr+W → שׁ
◌ׂ◌	sin dot	s = שׂ	AltGr + S	W, then AltGr+S → שׂ
◌ֹ◌	ḥolam on vav	ḥolam ḥaser	AltGr + V	V, then AltGr+V → i
◌ֽ	meteg	stress / pause	AltGr + M	בְּ
־	maqaf	Hebrew hyphen	AltGr + -	—
’	geresh	abbreviations, foreign sounds	AltGr + '	—
”	gershayim	acronyms	Shift + AltGr + '	—

Letter + mark in one keystroke

These keys type the letter with its mark directly, no second step.

Result	Name	Sound	Keys
שׁ	shin	sh	Shift + W
וּ	shuruq	u	Shift + U
i	ḥolam male	o	Shift + O
לֹ	lamed + ḥolam	lo	Shift + L
ײַ	pasekh tsvey yudn (Yiddish)	ai	Shift + I or]

Uninstalling

The keyboard is removed from Settings like any other program, followed by a restart.

1. Open **Settings → Apps → Installed apps**.
2. Search for **Niqqud**.
3. Next to “Hebrew QWERTY + Niqqud” click **“…” → Uninstall** and confirm.
4. **Restart the computer.**

To only hide it from the Win + Space list without uninstalling: Settings → Time & language → Language & region → Hebrew → **“…” → Language options** → **Keyboards** → “…” next to the keyboard → **Remove**. You can add it back from the same place with **Add a keyboard**.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Cause	Fix
In Word, a bar of yellow letters appears when I press Alt	left Alt was used, or the old keyboard is selected	Esc; use right Alt or Ctrl+Alt; check the keyboard with Win+Space
AltGr + letter types nothing	another Hebrew keyboard is selected	Win+Space → choose “Hebrew QWERTY + Niqqud”
Win+Space shows only “Hebrew”, without the full name	Windows 11 does not display names of custom keyboards	pick by the order in Settings → Keyboards, or run the command below
The mark appears next to the letter, not on it	the mark was typed before the letter	type the letter first, then the mark
(qamaṣ qatan) shows as a box ◌	the font lacks this mark	use a font such as Times New Roman, SBL Hebrew or Ezra SIL
setup.exe does not start	files are missing from the folder	extract the whole folder and run setup.exe from it
Installation is refused	a version with the same name is already installed	uninstall, restart, then install again

Full name in the Win+Space list. Open PowerShell as administrator (Start → PowerShell → right-click → Run as administrator), paste the command, press Enter, then sign out and back in:

```
Get-ChildItem 'HKLM:\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control\Keyboard Layouts' | Where-Object { (Get-ItemProperty $_.PSPath).'Layout File' -ieq 'HebrewQN.dll' } | ForEach-Object { Set-ItemProperty $_.PSPath 'Layout Display Name' 'Hebrew QWERTY + Niqqud'; Set-ItemProperty $_.PSPath 'Layout Text' 'Hebrew QWERTY + Niqqud'; "Changed: " + $_.PSChildName }
```